

International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad

HS8.202: Gender, Culture and Representation

End Semester Examination

Max. Time: 03 hrs. Instructions:

Full Marks: 40

- Answer **any four** questions.
- All questions carry equal marks (10 marks each).
- Your answers should demonstrate close textual reading, critical insight, and conceptual clarity.

Questions

- ✓ Q1. Discuss how gender is constructed as performance in Mahesh Dattani's *Dance Like a Man*. How do Jairaj and Ratna negotiate societal expectations of masculinity and femininity?
- ✓ Q2. In *Alias Grace*, how does Margaret Atwood complicate the idea of truth and guilt? Discuss the role of memory, narration, and psychological ambiguity in shaping Grace Marks' identity.
- ✓ Q3. Discuss the theme of caste, gender, and marginalization in *Bayen* by Mahasweta Devi. How does the figure of the "bayen" function as both a site of oppression and resistance?
- Q4. Compare the representation of female subjectivity and resistance in any two of the following texts:
- *Alias Grace*
 - *Wide Sargasso Sea*
 - *Bayen*
 - *Sultana's Dream*
- Q5. Critically analyze *Sultana's Dream* by Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain as an utopian text. What does Ladyland reveal about gender roles, science, and power?
- Q6. "Literature reimagines what society suppresses."
Discuss this statement with reference to at least two texts from the syllabus, focusing on themes of gender, power, and social control.
- ✓ Q7. Analyze *Wide Sargasso Sea* as a postcolonial response to *Jane Eyre*. How does the novel challenge colonial and patriarchal narratives through Antoinette's voice?